हैदराबाद विश्वविद्यालय

UNIVERSITY OF HYDERABAD

Minutes of the 194th Meeting of the Executive Council held at 1.30 p.m. on June 27, 2025, in the Vice Chancellor's Conference Hall at the Administration Building of the University

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Members Present:

Prof. B.J. Rao	Vice-Chancellor & *ex officio* Chairman
Prof. Manisha Sharma	Visitor's nominee
Prof. Vandana Mishra	Visitor's nominee (attended online)
Prof. E. Sujatha	Visitor's nominee
Prof. Atul Negi	Dean, School of Computer & Information Sciences
Prof. Jai Prakash Gautam	Dean, School of Engineering Sciences & Technology (attended online)
Prof. Anand Kumar Kondapi	Dean, School of Life Sciences
Dr. C. George Tharakan	Senior-most Associate Professor (attended online)
Dr. P. Anupama	Senior-most Assistant Professor
Dr. Devesh Nigam	Registrar & *ex officio* Secretary
Shri B. Srinivas	Finance Officer, Special Invitee

Prof. Pravesh Kumar Srivastava, Visitor's nominee, Prof. Saroj Panigrahi, Dean (Mathematics & Statistics), Prof. Arun Patnaik, Seniormost Professor, and Dr. B. Jagadeesh, Alumni Nominee, could not attend the meeting due to other preoccupations.

The Chairman warmly welcomed the Members, especially Prof. Jai Prakash Gautam, Dean, School of Engineering Sciences & Technology, Prof. Anand Kumar Kondapi, Dean, School of Life Sciences, Prof. Vandana Mishra and Prof. E. Sujatha, Visitor's nominees, and Shri B. Srinivas, Finance Officer as a Special Invitee; who are attending the meeting for the first time and expressed gratitude for the contributions of the outgoing members, Prof. Ashwini Kumar Nangia, Prof. K.C. James Raju, Prof. Geetha K. Vemuganti, Prof. Jyothirmaya Sharma and Prof. T.P. Radhakrishnan.

The Council was then apprised of the events and activities that took place in the University since its last meeting of the Executive Council held on November 4, 2024, of which a few significant events were highlighted.

Thereafter, the agenda items for the meeting were taken up for deliberation by the members.

Item No. EC:194:2025:1

To confirm the minutes of the meetings of the 193rd Executive Council and Special Executive Council.

The minutes of the 193rd meeting of the Executive Council held on November 4, 2024, and the meeting of the Special Executive Council held on March 20, 2025, were approved.

Item No. EC:194:2025:2

To report on the action taken on the minutes of the 193rd meeting and the Special meeting of the Executive Council.

The reports of the action taken on the minutes of the 193rd meeting and the Special meeting of the Executive Council were tabled and taken on record.

Item No. EC:194:2025:3

Report on the action taken by the Vice-Chancellor

The Council considered the action taken by the Vice Chancellor during the period November 2024 to date

(i) In appointing Deans of Schools, Heads of Departments & Centres, Director & Associate Directors of IQAC, Director-in-charge of MMTTC and Librarian-in-charge

(ii) Sanctioning sabbatical leave and Extraordinary Leave

(iii) Relieving Prof. P. Prakash Babu on deputation to assume charge as the Vice Chancellor of the Pondicherry University and Dr. Manoj Deori, Assistant Professor, on his resignation

(iv) Appointment of Dr. Nandini Ramesh Sankar as Associate Professor in the Department of English and Dr. B. Ananda Sagar as Professor in the Department of Philosophy on direct recruitment, and

(v) Promotion of teachers under UGC-CAS.

Item No. EC:194:2025:4

To consider and approve the (i) recommendations of the Selection Committee (s) for appointment of faculty (direct recruitment) and promotions of teachers under the Career Advancement Scheme and (ii) recommendations of the Screening-cum-Evaluation Committee (s) for placement of teachers in the next higher Academic Level under Career Advancement Scheme during 16th to 22nd June, 2025.

The recommendations of the Selection Committee (s) for direct recruitment of faculty and promotion of teachers under the provisions of the UGC-CAS and Screening-cum-Evaluation Committee (s) for placement of the teachers in the next higher Academic level under the provisions of UGC-CAS in various Schools/ Departments/ Centres held during 16th – 22nd June, 2025 were considered and approved for their implementation.

Item No. EC:194:2025:5

To consider important letters received from the Ministry and UGC:

The following clarifications of the UGC vide its letter F. No. 5-15/2025(PS) dated 18-06-2025 in matters of CAS-promotions were considered and approved for implementation:

1. If a candidate is not successful in the first assessment, his/her promotion shall be affected either from 1st January or 1st July, depending upon the date of the eventual assessment on their application for re-assessment after one year under the UGC Regulations, 2018.
2. The provisions of the 3rd Amendment Regulations concerning the date of promotion apply even if the application for reassessment was submitted before the notification of the regulations on August 1, 2023, if the eventual successful assessment took place after that date under the UGC Regulations, 2018.
3. A candidate who does not succeed in the first assessment, either under the 2010 or 2018 Regulations, will be re-assessed only after one year.
4. The 4th Amendment Regulations apply only to faculty members who are already qualified or are likely to qualify as per UGC Regulations, 2010, up to 31st December, 2024; they do not apply to teachers appointed under the 2018 Regulations.

Item No. EC:194:2025:6

To approve the Minutes of the 88th meeting of the Finance Committee of UoH held on 25th June, 2025.

The Minutes of the 88th meeting of the Finance Committee of UoH held on 25th June, 2025, were considered and resolved to be approved.

Item No. EC:194:2025:7

To consider and approve the draft Annual Accounts of the University for the Financial Year 2024-25 for onward transmission to the C&AG of India for the conduct of the Audit

The draft Annual Accounts of the University for the Financial year 2024-25, approved by the Finance Committee in its 88th meeting held on 25th June, 2025, were considered and approved for forwarding them to the Principal Director of Audit (Central), Hyderabad for auditing, after incorporation of any necessary corrections with the approval of the Vice-Chancellor.

Item No. EC:194:2025:8

To consider the minutes of the meetings of the 94th and 95th Academic Council held on 22.11.2024 and 25.04.2025, respectively.

The Council resolved to approve the minutes of the 94th and 95th meetings of the Academic Council held on 22.11.2024 and 25.04.2025, respectively, after noting the highlights and significant issues/events captured in the minutes.

Approvals were accorded to the following significant proposals of the 95th AC:

- Adoption of the Scopus and Web of Science indexed journals/publications for direct recruitment and promotion due to the withdrawal of the CARE journals by the UGC.
- Change of name of the Centre for Study of Social Exclusion and Inclusive Policy to "Centre for the Study of Social Inclusion."\

Item No.EC:194:2025:9

To consider the amendments to Chapter I of the Academic Ordinances following the change of the names of ACRHEM to DIA-UOH, CHP to CP and CSSEIP to CSSI.

The Council resolved to approve the proposed amendments to Chapter I of the Academic Ordinances of the University with a change of the names of the Advanced Centre for High Energy Materials (ACRHEM) as DRDO-Industry-

Academia Centre of Excellence (DIACOE)- UOH, the Centre for Health Psychology (CHP) as the Centre for Psychology (CP) and the Centre for Study of Social Exclusion and Inclusive Policy (CSSEIP) as the Centre for Study of Social Inclusion (CSSI)

Item No.EC:194:2025:10

To consider the proposal for amending the first proviso to clause (1) of Statute 6 of the Statutes of the University of Hyderabad, raising the maximum age for holding the office of Dean to 65 years.

The Council resolved to approve the following proposed amendment to Clause (1) of Statute 6:

Existing Clause (1) of Statute-6	**Clause (1) of Statute-6 after amendment**
Every Dean of a School of Studies shall be appointed by the Vice-Chancellor from among the Professors in the School for a period of three years, and he shall be eligible for re-appointment	Every Dean of a School of Studies shall be appointed by the Vice-Chancellor from among the Professors in the School for a period of three years, and he shall be eligible for re-appointment
Provided that a Dean, on attaining the age of 60 years, shall cease to hold office.	Provided that a Dean, on attaining the age of 65 years, shall cease to hold office.
Provided further that if at any time there is no Professor in a School, the Vice-Chancellor or Pro-Vice-Chancellor, if authorized by the Vice-Chancellor in this behalf, shall exercise the powers of the Dean of the School.	Provided further that if at any time there is no Professor in a School, the Vice-Chancellor or Pro-Vice-Chancellor, if authorized by the Vice-Chancellor in this behalf, shall exercise the powers of the Dean of the School.

Item No.EC:194:2025:11

To consider the proposal for amending clause (2) of Statute 12 of the Statutes of the University of Hyderabad to define the term of the ex-officio members of the Executive Council.

In continuation of the amendment proposed to Clause (1) of Statute 12 to include the Secretary (Higher Education), Ministry of Education, Government of India or his/her nominee, ex-officio member, along with change of designations of Reader as Associate Professor and Lecturer to

Assistant Professor vide Item No. EC: 193:2024:11 in the 193rd meeting of the Council in its meeting held on November 4, 2024, the Council resolved to approve the proposed amendment to Clause (2) of Statute 12 as follows:

Existing Clause (2) of Statute 12	Clause (2) of Statute 12 after amendment
All members of the Executive Council, other than the Vice-Chancellor and the Pro-Vice-Chancellor, shall hold office for a term of three years	All members of the Executive Council, other than the ex-officio members, shall hold office for a term of three years.

Item No.EC:194:2025:12

To consider the policy for creating co-working spaces for research, entrepreneurial and academic activities (CREAA) in the university to promote academia-industry interactions in teaching, research, innovation and entrepreneurship and generation of internal revenue

The IOE Directorate and the Research & Development Cell of the University mooted a proposal for creating 'co-working spaces' within the university to undertake research, entrepreneurial and academic activities (CREAA) with the objective of not only utilizing and monetizing the infrastructure developed under the IOE project to its true potential, but also leveraging the expertise of the University fraternity, including its faculty members, students, alumni and non-teaching staff for a greater and direct societal impact mandated for a public funded institution. The model generates additional revenue at zero additional cost to the University. The Council was apprised of the framework of the policy and its salient features by the IOE Director through a PowerPoint Presentation.

Finding it a progressive initiative, the Council resolved to approve the proposal for creating co-working spaces for research, entrepreneurial, and academic activities (CREAA) at the university, aimed at engaging the community and alumni in promoting academia-industry interactions in teaching, research, innovation, and entrepreneurship, besides generating revenue for the university with no additional cost.

Item No. EC:194:2025:13

To consider restoring the operative strength of non-teaching staff (including staff & teachers of the Campus School) from 593 to its original sanctioned strength of 1394, given the operational difficulties.

Pending alignment of the faculty: non-teaching staff ratio to 1:1.1, no fresh recruitment has been made for non-teaching positions since 2012, in

compliance with the University Grants Commission (UGC)'s directions, vide its letter dated 09-01-2012. Subsequently, vide its letter No. F.8-1/2014(CU) dated 18-10-2021, the Commission permitted filling of vacancies in both teaching and non-teaching posts under mission-mode recruitment launched by the Central Government, subject to alignment of the teaching-non-teaching ratio to 1:1.1. and framing of CRRs for all the posts.

Based on the recommendations of Prof. Y.A. Sudhakar Reddy Committee, the Council, in its 190th meeting held on 30-06-2023, decided to restrict the operational strength of non-teaching posts from 1394 to 593, corresponding to 539 teaching posts, to align with the 1:1.1 ratio mandated by the Commission facilitating recruitment to non-teaching posts to at least partially resolve its acute shortage. Two recruitment notifications were issued thereafter for 147 non-teaching posts, and the recruitment process is being finalized for several posts.

However, observing that the restriction of operational strength from 1394 to 593 has a substantial and detrimental impact on the day-to-day functions of the University and the professional development of existing non-teaching staff, the University approached the Commission in May 2025 to permit it to restore the original sanctioned strength of 1394 in non-teaching posts.

The Council therefore resolved to reverse its earlier decision of restriction to 593 taken in its 190th meeting and restore the operative strength of the non-teaching staff of the University to its original sanctioned strength of 1394 for the optimal management of its infrastructure and resources, and to ensure smooth functioning of academic and administrative functions, subject to the approval of the University Grants Commission.

Item No. EC:194:2025:14

To consider providing medicines for chronic ailments to employees retired under all pension schemes and their dependent family members (spouse) up to a ceiling of Rs. 2,500/- under the Pharmacy-II facility till it exists

The Council in its 188th meeting held on June 28th, 2022 decided, *inter alia*, to supply medicines for chronic ailments up to the monetary limit of Rs 2500/- to the serving employees and up to the limit of Rs.1000/- to retired employees, who were not eligible for or foregoing Fixed Medical Allowance under the Pharmacy-II facility.

Subsequently, based on their representations, the Vice Chancellor approved the supply of medicines worth up to a limit of Rs 2500/- under the Pharmacy-II facility to pensioners with effect from January 1st, 2023. However, on par with pensioners, those retired under the NPS and CPF schemes also availed the facility of drawing medicines from Pharmacy-II up to a ceiling of Rs. 2500/- from 01.01.2023 onwards.

Since the Pharmacy-II facility was introduced as a welfare measure to support serving and retired employees to offset the expenditure on the purchase of medicines required for chronic ailments, to some extent, irrespective of their pension scheme, the Council ratified the supply of medicines for chronic ailments up to a ceiling of Rs 2,500/- to all retired employees of the University, on par with serving employees, from January 1, 2023 onwards until the Pharmacy-II facility is continued.

Item No. EC:194:2025:15

To consider the grant of vigilance clearance for promotion after the currency of the penalty period in cases of imposition of statutory penalties under disciplinary proceedings

The Council resolved to implement the provisions of the DOPT OM No. F.No.22034/4/2012-Estt. (D) dated 02-11-2012, read with O.M. No.22011/4/2007 dated 28-04-2014, facilitating the issue of vigilance clearance to University employees awarded any statutory penalty after the conclusion of the period of penalty.

Item No. EC:194:2025:16

In compliance with the resolution of the Executive Council in its 192nd Meeting held on 28.06.2024 to merge the Mahatma Gandhi National Council of Rural Education (MGNCRE), Hyderabad with the University of Hyderabad and absorption of its staff against the existing vacancies in the University in pursuance of the directions of the Ministry of Education, the following three permanent staff members of the MGNCRE, are mapped against vacant posts of the university:

The Council resolved to approve the restoration of the pay scales/levels of Smt. Sapireddy Saroja, Private Secretary, of the erstwhile MGNCRE, to G.P.4600/- in the Pay Band-II (Pay Level-7) attached to her substantive post and the subsequent grant of the first financial upgradation to Pay Level-8 under MACPS.

Item No.EC:194: 2025:17

To consider the appointment of retired Faculty members of the University as Emeritus Professors:

The Council resolved to appoint Prof. Podile Appa Rao, Prof. T.P. Radhakrishnan, and Prof. S. Dayananda as Emeritus Professors from 29-05-2025, 01-06-2025 and 27-06-2025, respectively, for three years or till their attaining the age of 70 years, whichever is earlier.

Item No.EC:194:2025:18

To recover the balance amount of adhoc bonus paid, in two instalments from the Dearness Relief payable to Pensioners for May and June 2025

Based on the authority given by the University Grants Commission vide its letter F.No.25-4/2007(CU) dated 13.06.2011, the University was paying Dearness Allowance/Relief at enhanced rates and Non-Productivity Linked Bonus (Adhoc bonus) to its employees and pensioners by downloading the orders issued by the Ministry of Finance (Department of Expenditure) from time to time. The ad hoc bonus for the years 2015-16 & 2016-17 was also paid similarly to eligible non-teaching employees.

However, the Commission vide letter No. F.25/4/2007(CU) dated 18.10.2017 communicated that the Government of India did not extend the benefit of adhoc bonus to the employees of autonomous bodies for the years 2015-16 and 2016-17 and directed the University to recover it from the employees concerned if already paid. The Public Accounts Committee (PAC) of the Parliament, in its 62nd Report raised the matter of irregular payment of adhoc bonus to employees of autonomous bodies, following which the Ministry of Education, Department of Higher Education, directed the University to make recovery of the amounts of adhoc bonus paid for the years 2015-16 and 2016-17 and to submit an Action taken Report to it.

In compliance with the directions of the Ministry, the University recovered the amounts of bonus paid from the HRA arrears payable to serving employees, and one instalment from the Dearness Relief of Pensioners in the month of January 2025. Following representations from pensioners, further recovery from pensioners was put on hold, and their representations were forwarded to the Commission for consideration.

Meanwhile, having received stringent directions from the Ministry of Education *vide* its letter dated 01.05.2025 seeking a compliance report in the matter, the University decided to recover the balance two instalments also from the Dearness Relief payable to Pensioners for May and June 2025.

After careful consideration of the circumstances, the Council resolved to comply with the directions of the Ministry of Education and recover the balance two instalments of bonus paid to retired employees in May and June 2025, subject to the final decision of the Commission and the Ministry of Education.

ANY OTHER ITEMS:

Item No.EC:194:2025:19/1

Regulation of gratuity payable to employees covered under the National Pension System (NPS) to the ceiling prescribed under the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972

The Council resolved to limit the amount of retirement/death gratuity payable to the employees covered under the National Pension System (NPS) to the prevailing ceiling of Rs 20 lakh under the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972, till it is enhanced on par with other pension schemes.

Item No.EC:194:2025:19/2

Issues concerning the 400 acres of land in Kancha Gachibowli village:

The Council, in its Special Meeting held on March 20th, 2025, reviewed the matters about the land allotted to it by the State Government in 1975, subsequent exchange of land with the Government on their request, with the approval of the Council in 2003, and the legal battles fought to preserve the land allotted and the recent incident of development of the 400 acres of land by the TGIIC for setting up IT park in March, 2025 and decided to request the State Government to mutate the land allotted to it in its name and to preserve the biodiversity of the land. Follow-up letters were sent to the Chief Minister, Deputy Chief Minister, Revenue Minister, Chief Secretary and CCLA, etc., by the Vice-Chancellor.

The Council reviewed the subsequent developments, writ petitions filed by various stakeholders in the High Court, the *Suo motu* intervention by the Hon'ble Supreme Court of India and the status quo ordered by it.

The Council resolved to continue efforts for the mutation of the land in the name of the University to safeguard its interests.

Item No.EC:194:2025:19/3

To consider the appeal of five students who trespassed into the residence of the Vice Chancellor and held a noisy protest, disturbing the peace and sleep of the residents around 1.00 am on 18-05-2024

Since criminal cases of trespass under BNSS were registered against the students concerned, the Council resolved that it is not in its purview to withdraw the criminal proceedings.

Item No.EC:194:2025:19/4

To consider the appeal of Siddhant Shukla, Reg. No. 20IAME09, School of Economics on the imposition of suspension & expulsion from hostel for one year

After careful consideration of the appeal and the circumstances that led to the imposition of the penalty, the Council resolved to confirm the penalty imposed.

Item No.EC:194:2025:19/5

To consider the appeal of Prof. Ramdas Rupavath against the penalty imposed in the 193rd meeting of the Executive Council in November 2024 and to define the purview of the term 'administrative position.'

After careful consideration of the appeal of Prof. Ramdas Rupavath, the Council decided that there were no extenuating grounds presented by him that warranted a review or abatement of the restriction of not allowing him to hold administrative positions for five years imposed on him.

After perusal of the complaints of the students and related correspondence, Ms. Mohana Motha and Ms. Shiwani Dhingra, the Council took a serious note of the apathetic and callous attitude of Prof. Ramdas in matters concerning awarding of marks and score sheets of the subjects taught by him, jeopardizing the future of his students, besides employing an unprofessional, dismissive and defiant attitude towards academic and administrative compliances. The Council, therefore, resolved to issue a show-cause notice to him for these transgressions and place them before a committee, to be constituted, for their examination.

The Council further resolved that, in the event of such restrictions being imposed in future, administrative positions shall refer only to the statutory positions of Dean of a School and Head of a Department, unless other specific restrictions are also imposed.

Item No. EC:194:2025:19/6

To consider the records of the disciplinary action initiated against Dr. C. Gangadhar, Senior Medical Officer, University Health Centre, for misconduct

In culmination of the disciplinary proceedings initiated against him, the Council resolved to impose the minor penalty of 'Censure' on Dr. G. Gangadhar, Senior Medical Officer, in addition to ordering recovery of the conveyance allowance paid for the period January to May, 2025 and withholding the payment of the allowance for June, 2025.

Item No. EC:194:2025:19/7

To consider the request of Prof. Ravi Ranjan to permit him to opt for voluntary retirement from the university service

The Council resolved to permit Prof. Ravi Ranjan to opt for voluntary retirement in terms of provisions of the Fundamental Rule 56K or Rule 48 of the CCS (Pension) Rules, 1972.

Item No. EC:194:2025:19/8

To consider the funds allocated and expenditure incurred under the Institute of Eminence project

The Council reviewed the physical and financial progress of the IOE project through a presentation made by Prof. Ghanshyam Krishna, Director, IOE and expressed its appreciation for the efforts of the IOE Directorate.

The Council resolved to pursue for the extension of the IOE project by one more year, till the end of Financial Year 2025-26 and seek sanction of funds to the tune of Rs 129 crore to meet the expenditure on additional commitments made in the second half of the FY 2024-25 under OH 31 and OH 35, in anticipation of extension of the project and grant of additional funds.

Item No. EC:194:2025:19/9

To consider the issues concerning promotion to the Senior Professor position

The position of Senior Professor, in the Academic Pay Level-15, came into being from 18th July, 2018 under the UGC Regulations, 2018. A Professor with ten years' experience in the grade, and a minimum of ten publications and two PhD degrees successfully awarded under his/her supervision during the assessment period, is eligible for the position. Unlike for promotions from other positions up to the post of Professor, there were no specific CAS promotion criteria or research score prescribed in the regulations for promotion from Professor to Senior Professor.

To make good this lacuna, the Executive Council in its 180th meeting held on December 1, 2018, decided to constitute a committee for the purpose of laying down a framework (template-data sheet) for assessment of the academic and research achievements as in other CAS promotions. The recommendations of the Prof. Agarwal Committee and their adoption were reported to the 181st meeting of the Council, and CAS promotions to the grade of Senior Professor

are being made as per these norms, subject to the fulfilment of the eligibility criteria laid down in the UGC Regulations, 2018, to date.

Since the UGC recognizes only three grades of teachers, namely Assistant Professor, Associate Professor, and Professor, the Council resolved to obtain clarification from the Commission whether the ceiling of 10% of sanctioned posts of Professor applicable for direct recruitment to the grade of Senior Professor in the UGC Regulations, 2018 also applies for CAS promotions, and to withhold promotions to the Senior Professor grade till a clarification is received from the Commission.

Item No. EC:194:2025:19/10

Appeals of faculty for advancing their dates of promotion

After careful consideration of the appeals from a few faculty members for advancing their dates of promotion, the Council resolved to constitute a committee to examine the appeals and the circumstances leading to them, and make suitable recommendations for their consideration, subject to the approval of the University Grants Commission.

Item No. EC:194:2025:19/11

Reporting of the ANRF-PAIR Grant and HAL-CSR Grants

The Director (R&D) apprised the Council of the University being chosen for the prestigious Anusandhan National Research Foundation-Partnerships for Accelerated Innovation and Research (ANRF-PAIR) Grant for research and innovation in health and medical technologies, in partnership with its six Spoke Institutions and 173 Co-Principal Investigators.

Expressing its appreciation to the authorities of the Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd. (HAL) for the CSR-Grant of Rs. 5.00 crore, the Council resolved to approve (i) establishment of 'UOH-HAL Centre of Excellence (CoE) in Digital Twin Technology Laboratory', and (ii) naming of one identified auditorium in the Interdisciplinary Research Centre Building of the Institute of Eminence as the 'UOH-HAL-CENTRE OF EXCELLENCE AUDITORIUM.'

The meeting concluded with the Chairman thanking all the members for their valuable contributions and time

Prof. B. J. Rao
Chairman